

Building Faith

Transcript of the God's Design podcast episode

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Good day and welcome to this podcast. I'm your host Ashton. Today we're going to do a new series called Building Faith. In this podcast we're going to address some of the wrong thinking that is currently plaguing the church members in their belief systems about what the Word says about faith, what faith truly is, what faith isn't, and how to operate in faith correctly. Romans chapter 10 verse 17 says, So faith cometh by hearing, hearing by the Word of God.

If you truly press into church members and sit and have a discussion with them regarding certain things that are not happening for their lives and ask them why do you think or believe that it is not happening for your life, somewhere deep down you'll get a response, maybe it is just enough for me. And other times you will hear people say, well in God's time this will happen or another one will say, you have to have the faith of Abraham and another one will say something else.

But when you really listen to what they say, if they really open themselves up, if they are truly vulnerable with you, they will truly say these words, One of the common thoughts that plague the church is that it's for others, just not for me. And I know many people have this belief system when they see things happening for other people and they just don't see it ever happening for their lives. And so they make this inner vow with the inside of them that I will come to church, I will attend all the church services, I will clap the hands, I'll pray the prayers.

But I know it is not for me. One of Jesus' biggest battles upon the earth was getting people to believe in the word that he preached and then act on that which he had preached to them. He came to move people away from dead works, back into the faith that Abraham had toward God. Unfortunately, today, many people are duped into thinking that if they put money inside of the collection tray, that that money is going to supernaturally release God's blessings that they should have faith for into their lives.

But this was never preached by Jesus Christ in the first place. When he used the parable of the seed, he used that to show that what is planted in good soil will produce that which the sower

so desires. One of the first things we're going to have to get to grips with is that your life starts in the spiritual, long before it started in the physical. So, in the spiritual realm, you have a spirit man that operates inside of the spirit realm. This spirit realm, your spirit man, does not sleep at all.

Your natural body will sleep to have rest, but your spirit man will stay awake continuously. It does not sleep. Everything, therefore, that's going to happen to you starts within the spiritual realm. And when you have agreed with it, when your spirit man has agreed with it, then it... Will be released to you in the natural realm. All your battles you ever gonna fight, you will have to first fight them in the realm of the Spirit. When you have conquered and succeeded in the realm of the Spirit, then the physical aspect will work itself out.

When Jesus taught, he said, in the prayer of the Our Father, Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Basically saying that we as Christians should mirror what is going on in the realm of the Spirit here upon the earth and not do our own things according to what our mind perceives to be correct. God has a way, a word, and a desired outcome for everybody's life here upon the earth who will be obedient to him. Creation is a complex thing for our minds to understand.

In order for Jesus to make us grasp the foundation of faith, He used very common, well-known examples of the day that everyone could understand. But unfortunately, faith doesn't seem to be an easy thing to grasp for many people in its simplicity. The issues that prevent people from operating in God's faith can vary from doctrine, beliefs, religion, or even having a false sense of humility. Some of the biggest delusions we have to faith is a works mentality.

This is where you are so busy in the busyness of being in church that you think that all of that busyness, cleaning the church, stacking up of chairs, serving, all of that would constitute faith. There is a big difference from knowing about faith and operating in faith, two things that are totally separate from each other. Hebrews 6, verses 1-3 reads, Therefore, leaving the principles of the doctrines of Christ, let us go on unto perfection, not laying again the foundation of repentance from dead works, and of faith towards God.

So faith has a direction. The direction of faith is towards God. Many people, when they ask for things in faith, they look at the outcome of the situation. If it doesn't look like it's going to happen, quickly they lose their faith. Verse 2 reads, Of the doctrine of baptisms, and laying on of hands, and of resurrection of the dead, and of eternal judgment, and this will we do if God permits. The spectrum of faith in a Christian's life is very large.

It does not point to things. It points to God. And God responds to faith. God doesn't respond to your works. He doesn't respond to how good you look, how well you dress. He responds to

your faith. He doesn't even respond to your tiding. But it is to your faith that He responds. And if that ruffles a little bit of feathers, you can go to the book of Haggai and read what the prophet Haggai said to the people, You offer much, but you receive little. Basically saying, Your dead works before God is not yielding what you thought you would receive.

Jesus in the scriptures used One of the very common examples, he said in order for you to build a building, you have to build it upon a rock. The foundation of that building must rest upon a rock so that when the storms of life come, when the winds, the waters, that building will stand and not be moved by the turmoils of life. And so with the many doctrines that are floating around today in Christianity, if you are not planted on the correct foundation, the foundation which was chosen by God in the first place, that is Jesus Christ.

Then when the storms of life come in your direction and you start falling and you start falling apart, then you've got to realize that the foundation you're standing upon, that which you've chosen to see within yourself, is not really from God. Your spiritual life depends upon you being built on a firm foundation laid by God himself, which is Jesus Christ. He is the rock upon which you should build and build only upon that rock. 2 Timothy 2 verse 19 reads, As the world when passeth, so is the wicked no more, but the righteous is an everlasting foundation.

The foundations are laid by God, and us who have received Christ will build upon that which is known by God. 1 Corinthians 3 verse 11 reads, For other foundation can no man lay than that is laid, which is Jesus Christ. Our spiritual life is based on Christ Jesus. It means no man or man-made program, man-made doctrines, foods, songs, rituals, religious observance, religious organizations and affiliations can be what we perceive as having faith or a spiritual life.

God can only build on Jesus Christ. You cannot fake faith. Your appearance, your image, your dress, your works, all of that cannot fake faith. All of your labors must be built on him. So when the storms come, you will be able to stand and be unshaken. Matthew 7 verse 24 to 25 reads, And I'm just going to paraphrase it. I'm just going to break it down. It says, Whosoever cometh to me, heareth my sayings, and doeth them. We cannot leave out one step.

We come to the Master. We hear his instructions. Then we go and do them. Jesus recognized that to get to the bedrock, to get to the rock upon which people need to stand on, that we as the seekers of God need to dig deep. Most builders will dig deep until they strike rock. Once they have found the rock, they will start laying the foundation. And Jesus said, Those who dig deep will find the rock. So when you find the foundation, when you find the rock, it is only then can you live out the word of God.

Then will your faith start truly growing. Your logic is a hindrance in faith. There are no maybes, there is no reasoning with God's commands, and also nobody is excluded from doing them. There are no free passes. This is the difference between people who hear the word, and then people who hear the same word, but act out the word they have received. So be careful of what you are listening to, and what has been preached to you. It is your responsibility to hear correctly.

So let's look at Luke chapter 17 verses 5 to 7. And the Apostle said unto the Lord, Increase our faith. And the Lord said, If he had faith as a grain of a mustard seed, he might say unto the sycamine tree, Be thou plucked up by the root, and be thou planted in the sea, and it should obey you. Now, when you read the entire context of the conversation and teaching that Jesus was giving to his disciples, it was based upon, he had said to them that they should forgive 70 times 7.

Now, back in the day, in the Jewish traditions, the rule was three times a day. So Peter said, Well, let's increase it to seven times. And Jesus said, Seventy times seven. And when I was contemplating on 70, this was in the evening, the Lord said to me, Seventy is the year of release, is the number of release. And so Jesus was saying, The year of release times seven. And seven is the number of righteousness. So you will release them into righteousness.

Seventy times seven. And they said to him, But this is impossible. Because the answer is 500 and something. But what Jesus was actually saying to them, he was making a comparison. He said, Don't look at how large the task is. If you have faith as small as a mustard seed, that large task that you perceive will not be as large as you have imagined it to be. Because if you follow the command of the master, then you would easily overcome what he is asking you to do.

And so our forgiveness is not rooted within our logic. It is not rooted within how many times we must forgive. It is actually rooted within our faith. They asked Jesus to increase their faith. Jesus said, Obey my word. Coming back to us protecting our ears so that we hear correctly to stand in faith. Romans 10 verse 14 says, How then shall they call on him in whom they have not believed? And how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard? And how shall they hear without a preacher? Correct faith will come from correct preaching.

You will not have the required faith if you haven't heard the necessary word. When Jesus was confronted with the man whose son had a demon for many years, the man said to Jesus, Help my unbelief. That man had to be reprogrammed in his thinking. Because. Because. Thank you. All the years of people telling him that, well, it is something that he's going to have to live with, had to be undone so that he could receive the correct word for the healing for his son.

God has a word for every situation within our lives. It is our responsibility to seek out the word of God, stand upon the foundations that were laid, which is Christ Jesus, and then stand in an unwavering manner, not shaken by circumstances or situations, and believe God for that which we have prayed for. Hebrews chapter 2 verse 4 says, Again, I repeat this, it is your responsibility to hear correctly what has been preached unto you. It is your responsibility to not have itchy ears and run after the things that are not going to benefit you.

When you hear, you need to hear it in faith, and you need to obey that which you have heard. Submit to the word of God and the will of God, and things will then turn around in your favor, because you have not submitted to any form of doubt or shaking that is taking place within your life. So to wrap up this session, let's look at God's perspective on proper faith. We turn to the book of Deuteronomy chapter 7 verses 17, and God says, If thou shalt say in thine heart, these nations are more than I, how can I dispossess them? You see, your confession is very important, because God knows that your confession comes from your heart.

And if you have relegated God into not being able to do that which you require of Him, then He will not do that which is required of Him. He is saying to you, If you yourself do not believe I can do it, how then can I do it? You see, God's thoughts and opinions on the matter is very important. That one verse should shape the way you believe within your heart for the things that God wants to do for your life. It is up to you now to look and search your heart and see that which is not of God, not built in Christ, but rooted in man, rooted in gold, rooted in silver, built on whatever it is that you feel safe and comfortable in.

And it is your job to ask God to call down fire upon it so that it may be removed from you, so that when you dig deep, you find Christ. And upon that rock, you start building your faith and you start hearing what He has to say. You start doing His commands and you start receiving the things of God that you so require from God. My name is Ashton and this is the Building Faith series. I wish you well, may God bless you, and I hope you now realign your faith to the words of Jesus Christ, our Lord and Savior.

God bless you.